

Learning Experience Reflection

At the beginning of this course, I was honestly quite afraid of Business Analytics. During my first semester, I struggled a lot with the subject and never felt completely comfortable with coding or data analysis. Because of that experience, I started this semester with low confidence and expected it to be very difficult again.

However, this course turned out to be completely different from what I expected. One of the things I enjoyed most was that we were able to work on a project that genuinely interested us. This made the learning process much more engaging and meaningful.

A particularly valuable aspect of the course were the coaching sessions. I am very grateful that the professor offered these additional opportunities to ask questions and receive support whenever something was unclear. These sessions helped me overcome many obstacles and gave me confidence whenever I felt stuck.

Of course, the project was not always easy. There were many moments of frustration, confusion, and even a few mental breakdowns when our code would not work as expected. Data cleaning, creating visualizations, and especially working with Quarto for the final report often required several attempts before we achieved the desired result. Nevertheless, every small success motivated us to continue. As the project progressed, coding became less intimidating and gradually started to become enjoyable.

One of my proudest moments during this course was when we finally managed to make the `gganimate` function work. After many unsuccessful attempts, seeing our chart actually move in the presentation felt incredibly rewarding. It was a small feature, but it represented how much persistence and learning had gone into the project.

Interestingly, one of my best experiences related to this course happened outside the classroom. After finishing my tasks at work one day, I opened R Studio and the Quarto Presentation on my laptop to continue working on the project. My colleagues quickly became curious and gathered around me to see what I was doing. Soon even some of the managers joined the conversation. When I explained that I'm done for today but I wanted to stay a bit longer because I was working on a university data analytics project, they were genuinely impressed by what I had created. Receiving their compliments and encouragement made me realize how much I had learned throughout the semester. What had once seemed impossible to me was now something I could confidently demonstrate to others.

Looking back, this course completely changed my perception of Business Analytics. What started as a subject I feared became a subject I genuinely enjoyed. More importantly, it showed me that learning difficult skills requires patience, persistence, and practice. I am proud of the progress I made throughout the semester, and I believe that the knowledge and confidence I gained from this project will be valuable far beyond this course.

